

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

The musical score is written on four staves in 4/4 time with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The melody is simple and repetitive, using quarter and half notes. The lyrics are arranged in four parts, each corresponding to a staff. The first staff includes four numbered lines of lyrics. The second and fourth staves end with a double bar line. The third staff has a longer note value (half note) for the word 'heart'.

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...

Lord, I want to be a Chris - tian in my heart.

In my heart, in my heart,

Lord, I want to be a Chris - tian in my heart.